

How Dil Chahta Hai was built

A group trip decision tool for friends in India. The organiser shares one link and a PIN in WhatsApp. Everyone adds their budget, dates, trip type and deal-breakers. The app ranks 10 destinations from Pune so that nobody gets a trip they can't afford or hate, and the organiser marks the final choice.

● Live: dil-chahta-hai.vercel.app

3 days

from brief to live app

29

commits on main

243

automated tests, all passing

~8,000

lines of TypeScript

10

destinations, costed from Pune

WHAT IT RUNS ON

The stack

PIECE	USED FOR
Next.js 16.3 + React 19	The website and its server code together (App Router, Server Actions). Pages render on the server, so the phone gets finished HTML.
Tailwind CSS 4	Styling through design tokens: cream background, sunset-orange buttons, Goa-sea blue for decisions and focus rings.

PIECE	USED FOR
Fredoka + Nunito	Rounded, friendly display font for headings; readable body font.
Supabase (Postgres, Mumbai)	Stores trips, answers and the 10 destinations. Row-level security is on with no public access; only the server's secret key can read or write.
Vercel (Mumbai, bom1)	Hosting. Every push to main on GitHub goes live in about 2 minutes. A daily cron job keeps the free database awake.
Vitest 5	243 tests: the ranking maths, input checks, PIN and cookie rules, and a test that fails if any server action forgets its security check.
Wikimedia Commons	10 holiday photos under CC BY / BY-SA, resized to WebP/AVIF, credited at the bottom of every page.

HOW THE WORK WAS DONE

From brief to live, step by step

Claude Code (Opus) did the building. The owner made every product decision; the gstack skills gave each phase a fixed routine: think, plan, build, review, test, ship.

- 25 Sep

● Office hours: challenge the brief

/office-hours

 The scope was fixed by the brief. Only two questions were challenged: how to rank options fairly, and how to keep access simple without accounts. The result was a design doc that overrides the PRD where they differ.
- 25 Sep

● Engineering plan

/plan-eng-review

 Locked the architecture: 14 files, all database access on the server, every action behind a guard, Supabase and Vercel both in Mumbai, Vitest for tests, and a daily keep-alive.

25 Sep ● **Build the engine, in parallel**

Tasks T1–T5 and T7: scaffold, database schema, ranking engine, PIN and cookie access, server actions. Independent tasks ran as parallel agents, each in its own git worktree, then were merged.

26 Sep ● **Review checkpoints 1 and 2**

/review Found and fixed security gaps: PIN tries now lock the database row per attempt, regenerating the PIN also replaces the organiser link, and cookies expire on the server after 60 days.

26 Sep ● **Design system, three rounds**

ui-ux-pro-max Started clean, then warmer and more playful, then "vacation vibes": big photo headers of famous Indian and world places, photo cards for results, and a Domestic / International label.

26–27 Sep ● **Pages, three agents at once**

A shared UI kit first, then the create page, the trip home + answers form, and the organiser page were built in parallel and merged.

27 Sep ● **Real data**

Supabase project created in Mumbai, schema applied, and 10 destinations loaded with costs from Pune: Goa, Jaipur, Kerala, Manali, Rishikesh, Ladakh, Andaman, Bali, Santorini, Swiss Alps.

27 Sep ● **Review 3 and QA, side by side**

/review **/qa-only** Four reviewers (security, correctness, design and accessibility, attacker's view) read the code while a fifth agent clicked through every page at phone size. About 20 fixes followed, each covered by tests.

27 Sep ● **Ship**

Code merged to `main`, imported into Vercel, tested end to end on the live URL, a demo video recorded with Playwright, and all test trips deleted from the database.

Key decisions

Ranking: floor, then average

Brief said: rank by the worst-off person first.

An option fails if anyone is blocked by a deal-breaker, is over budget, or scores under 40. Passing options rank by group average, then lowest score, then cost.

Access: PIN + pick your name

No accounts or passwords for friends.

A 6-digit PIN (10 tries, then a 15-minute pause), a signed cookie, and an "Is this really you?" check that blanks the budget if someone else's answers are reopened.

Server-only database

Option: let the browser talk to Supabase.

The browser never talks to the database. Every read and write goes through server code that checks the PIN cookie or the organiser link first.

Budgets stay private

Friends shouldn't see each other's numbers.

No friend's budget ever reaches the page. Results only say "comfortable", "tight" or "over budget".

Deadline in IST

Phones in different time zones.

The deadline is stored as 11:59:59 PM IST and checked on the server, not the phone.

Final choice locks answers

When does voting end?

At the deadline, when the organiser locks early, or when a final choice is marked. Everyone then sees "Decided: Goa, 10–14 Nov".

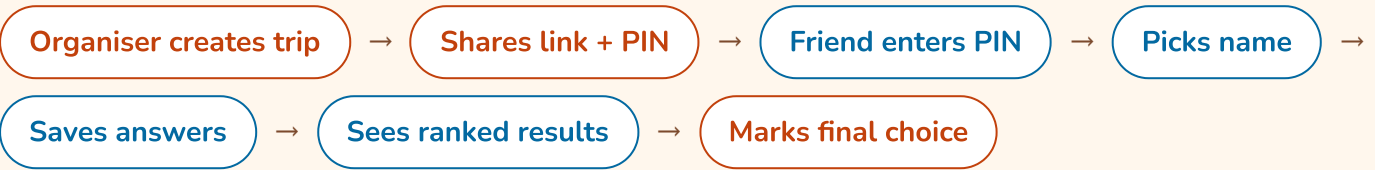
Toolbox

TOOL	WHAT IT DID HERE
Claude Code (Opus)	Wrote the code and tests, ran them, and coordinated the parallel agents.

TOOL	WHAT IT DID HERE
gstack skills	<code>/office-hours</code> (brief), <code>/plan-eng-review</code> (architecture), <code>/review</code> x3 (code review), <code>/qa-only</code> (browser testing).
ui-ux-pro-max	Design system: colours, fonts, components, page blueprints in <code>design-system/</code> .
Parallel agents + git worktrees	Independent tasks built at the same time on separate copies of the code, then merged.
Supabase connector	Created the project, applied migrations, tested the PIN function, and cleaned up test data.
GitHub + gh	Repo <code>milindmali1810/Dil-Chahta-Hai</code> ; also used to read Vercel's deploy status.
Vercel	Imported from GitHub by the owner, with 4 secret settings from <code>.env.local</code> .
Built-in browser + Playwright	Clicked through every flow at phone size, then recorded the demo video on the live site.

COMPONENT MAP

How the pieces fit



friend actions organiser actions public actions

Pages

What people see on their phone. app/

/

Create trip

Trip name, 2–10 people, 3–4 date options, deadline. Then the link, PIN and organiser link.

create-trip

created-screen

create-trip-input

/t/[tripId]

Trip home

PIN → Who are you? →

Home: who has answered, results, Decided banner.

pin-step

name-step

switch-row

status-pages

/t/[tripId]/form

Your answers

Budget (₹, from Pune), dates that work, trip type, deal-breakers. Locked after the deadline or a final choice.

answers-form

answers

/o/[tripId]/[token]

Organiser page

Share, who has answered, results with Mark as final, Lock / Unlock, Regenerate PIN.

organiser-controls

helpers

Shared UI kit

Reused by every page. app/ui/

page-shell

photo-header

photo-crossfade

photo-credits

button

submit-button

fields

choice

copy-field

notice

badge

status-list

results

decision-banner

confirm-dialog

save-this-link

icons

format

error page



Server boundary: every call re-checks the PIN cookie or the organiser link

Server actions

The only doors into the server. app/actions.ts

createTrip

enterPin

pickName

confirmName

switchName

saveResponse

lockEarly

unlock

regeneratePinAction

markFinal

clearFinalAction

Server rules

Checks, queries and maths.

`lib/`

access.ts

PIN check with try limits,
signed 60-day cookie,
`requireParticipant` and
`requireOrganiser`.

data.ts

Supabase queries and input
validation: names, dates,
deadline, budget.

scoring.ts

Pure ranking maths: floor,
then average. One card per
destination.

trip-view.ts

Builds what a trip page
shows: results, status rows,
header photo, decision. No
budgets.

photos.ts · trip-config.ts

Photo list with credits;
reference city Pune.

Data and hosting

Both in Mumbai.

Supabase Postgres

Tables `trips`, `responses`,
`destinations`, plus the
`try_pin()` function. No public
access.

Vercel

Hosts the app from `main`. Daily
cron calls `/api/keepalive` so
the free database never
sleeps.

CHECKED BY TESTS AND REVIEW

Promises the code keeps

The browser never talks to the database.

No friend's budget amount ever appears on a
page.

Every server action checks access first; a test
fails if one doesn't.

Only the trip name is visible before the PIN is
entered.

A lost connection shows a message, never a blank screen.

Every photo is credited to its photographer and licence.

NEXT TIME

Making a change

1. Edit the code in `D:\Dil-Chahta-Hai` on branch `build/v1`.
2. Run the checks: `npm test`, `npx tsc --noEmit`, `npm run lint`.
3. Merge into `main` and push. Vercel puts it live in about 2 minutes.

Full context for another Claude session is in `HANDOFF.md`; the design reasoning is in `docs/designs/group-trip-decision-tool.md`.

Dil Chahta Hai · built 25–27 September 2026 with Claude Code · photos from Wikimedia Commons under Creative Commons licences.